

Honesty Contract I

Honesty Contract II

Why a manifest, not a claim

A generator that produces a manuscript describing its own code faces an obvious temptation: assert a capability in prose without checking whether the capability exists. The abstract of this manuscript survived exactly this failure once — a hand-written “Tests: 371 · Coverage: 99.94%” line that no generator step had computed — and was corrected by replacing the literal numbers with `493 / 96.28` tokens filled in at render time by `scripts/02_measure_test_coverage.py`. `src/honesty.py` exists to make that class of failure structurally harder: every load-bearing claim in this manuscript must resolve to a named function in a named file, and a dedicated module inspects the source tree to confirm that resolution rather than trusting the prose that asserts it.

The framing is not incidental to a project named `template_autopoiesis`. An autopoietic system, in Maturana and Varela’s original sense, is one whose components participate in producing and verifying the very network of processes that produced them [Maturana_varela_1980] — organizational closure, not open-loop assertion. The honesty manifest is the narrow, literal, code-level